

s are sent out twice annually via Gainsight.

Feedback best practices for Advocates

We as a team should try our best to ensure the feedback we provide or the questions we ask customers, are clear and actionable.

Case feedback

Please refer to this document for best practices with examples. It is very important we follow these best practices as it gives us the best chance to influence Product and Sales System roadmaps.

Customer call recordings or emails

Direct feedback from customers should be provided in one of two channels:

1. Case feedback: ideally, your customer interaction is linked to a case. When closing the case, please link the Gong call recording with a brief summary of what the call consists of. For emails, feel free to copy + paste the email into the feedback field. Alternatively, you can screenshot the email, save it on your gdrive, and link it within the feedback field.
1. hvs channel: if your customer interaction cannot be linked to a specific case, please post the call recording (example) or an email screenshot in the feedback Slack channel. Again, this should be accompanied with a brief summary describing the problem and potentially the suggested solution.

hvs channel

For any other feedback not connected to a case or customer interaction, please post it in the feedback channel as well. Similar to a customer feedback, any example available to outline the feedback is strongly recommended. For example, if you are unable to complete a Salesforce action, please provide the screenshot of the error you are receiving.

Feedback actioning

Depending on the type of feedback, we will pursue one of the following routes:

HVS Leadership issue

Any feedback stemming from the above-stated resources that can be actioned on by HVS leadership (e.g. case type update), will be actioned in through an issue creation.

See an example issue of how HVS leadership logged and will action on feedback items stemming from recent team onsite.

Sales systems or Sales ops issue

Any feedback that concerns SFDC object updates, automation logic, and sales tooling will be pursued by HVS leadership by engaging with the appropriate systems or sales ops team.

For example, Advocates in Q3 provided feedback on further automating case actions, especially with Groove Flows. The HVS leadership team created this issue to kickstart exploring automation opportunities.

HVS <> Product intake issue

Any feedback that points to productization will follow this agreed upon intake-model with Product. This intake model places further emphasis on making sure the original feedback we gather has specific examples and screenshots, so Product can prioritize our items first.

Ad-hoc feedback items

Any feedback items that may be smaller in nature, or just require clarification, will start first in the appropriate slack channel of the team best fit to support. Below are some examples:

- Thread about updating payment instructions on Airbase with the Finance team
- Thread about a single customer needing assurances for outages with the Support team
- Thread about Customers Portal disclaimer clarification with the Product team. This has now become a Product intake issue.

Feedback progress updates

The HVS team will be kept up to date on any feedback they provided weekly through the Friday Weekly SMB update Alert in the hvsteam channel. In this update, we will callout any feedback item we are pursuing, and link the appropriate issue if needed.

Feedback dashboard

The HVS Feedback Tableau dashboard is how the team will monitor most of the feedback sources. The has created views on each feedback source in one workbook, making it easily accessible to read and action on said feedback.

Case feedback

- Visual: a tabular view of all case feedback
- Fields: Case Owner, Region, Case Type, Case Subject, Description, Date, Resolution Action, Feedback Type, Feedback
- Timeline: Trailing 1-2 weeks

Portal cancels summary

- Visual: stacked graph
- Fields: Month, Cancel Reason, SaaS, Self-Managed
- Timeline: Trailing 6 months

Portal cancels details

- Visual: a tabular view of all customer cancel events with text field
- Fields: Date, Cancel Reason, Text field, SaaS, Self-Managed

- Timeline: Trailing 3-4 weeks

CSAT/NPS

Survey results are analyzed and made available in the following formats:

- Tableau Dashboards: Created from Snowflake data, these dashboards provide a visual representation of overall CSAT trends, key metrics, and actionable insights.
- Gainsight: CSAT scores are comprehensively tracked in the Customer 360, providing a detailed view of customer satisfaction over time. Additionally, a universal dashboard offers a consolidated overview of all CSAT surveys sent, enabling easy monitoring and analysis.
- Salesforce: Survey responses can also be found in the embedded Gainsight widget on any account page in Salesforce.

DRIs

Below are the DRIs to facilitate the investigation of the appropriate feedback type. This does not mean this individual would solution the feedback, but they would bring the problem to the appropriate team.

Task	Responsibility	Primary DRI(s)	Secondary DRI(s)
Dashboard maintenance			

- Maintain and improve feedback

@Gsodhi

@mfleisher

- Monitor case feedback weekly or bi-weekly to identify notable feedback
- Involve additional HVS leadership team members if needed, and then create appropriate issue to kickstart investigation

- Gain additional examples if needed from advocates or support

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<td>Portal cancels feedback facilitation</td>

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- Monitor portal feedback details weekly to identify any notable feedback to report similarly as case feedback

- Analyse customer feedback trends monthly to identify any actionable items, covert to an issue

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<td>CSAT / NPS result analysis</td>

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- Summarize and share CSAT / NPS findings periodically

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@mhanks

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<td>Gong calls analysis</td>

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- Leverage Smart Trackers to analyze any product-related feedback periodically

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Call recordings, customer emails, or ad-hoc posts on hvs channel
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- Reply to advocate feedback
- Investigate feedback and create appropriate issue

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<td colspan="2">The DRI for this is flexible to the feedback subject</td>
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SECTION: sales/commercial/renewals-faq.md

Customer Renewals FAQ

Currently, many GitLab customers have questions regarding their upcoming subscription renewal.

Internally, GitLab employees often have similar questions regarding the upcoming renewal opportunities they manage.

Due to multiple purchase paths, deployment types, contract terms, & overage/ reconciliation processes, is it often unclear how to action a renewal that is upcoming.

This page aims to answer the most commonly asked questions regarding a customers renewal.

Customer Focused Questions

Q: When is my GitLab subscription going to renew?

A: Sign in to the Customers Portal to see the renewal or expiry date.

Q: Where can I manage my GitLab subscription and upcoming renewal?

A: Once signed into the Customers Portal, you will see various options regarding your subscription, including Upgrade Plan, Add More Seats, and dropdown list option for additional actions like Buy GitLab Duo Pro.

Q: Will my GitLab subscription auto-renew?

A: Please review this section of the GitLab documentation that explains where to check on your subscription card.

Q: Will I be notified about my upcoming renewal?

A: Yes! 30 days before a subscription expires, a banner with the subscription expiry date displays for administrators in the GitLab user interface. If your subscription is on auto-renew, you will also receive an email notification.

Q: When my GitLab subscription is due for renewal, am I able to add or remove licenses?

A: 15 days before your subscription expires, you will see a Renew button under your existing subscription in the Customers Portal. This will allow you to adjust your user quantity.

You cannot manually renew your subscription more than 15 days before the subscription expires. Please review this section of GitLab documentation for instructions on how to manually renew..

Please be aware that if you do not renew manually, you will be auto-renewed.

Q: I see I was charged for a Quarterly Subscription Reconciliation. What is this for?

A: Quarterly reconciliation occurs when you exceed your license limit. You will be charged an overage based on the maximum number of seats you used during the quarter. If you ever go over the maximum, you will get a warning on your GitLab instance.

More information on this can be found [here](#).

If you want to contest these overages, you can open an Support Ticket and select the problem type Quarterly Subscriptions Reconciliation (QSR) Related Problems.

Q: In the GitLab Customers Portal, I see the option to cancel my subscription from the dropdown list. What happens if I click cancel?

A: In the Customers Portal, if the Cancel subscription option is available then this means auto-renew is turned on. Clicking Cancel subscription turns off auto-renew. You will still have access to your paid features until the subscription expiration date.

Q: Will having add-ons affect my renewal process?

A: Subscriptions with Duo Pro, Duo Enterprise, or Enterprise Agile Planning cannot auto-renew. You will see a banner asking you to contact the sales team for assistance. If you know your Account Executive, please contact them directly.

Q: My GitLab subscription is due for renewal, and I would like to renew. How do I do this?

A: Please see the below content on how to renew, based on your hosting model.

SaaS Subscription - How to Renew

Self Managed Subscription - How to Renew

Q: During my GitLab subscription term, am I able to remove unused licenses and receive a refund for these?

A: No, this is not possible at this time.

Q: I purchased a GitLab.com subscription through a sales person. How do I activate my purchase and apply my paid subscription to my group?

A: See this short video to learn how to link your GitLab.com subscription to your group. Before taking the steps described in the video, be sure that you have the Owner role for the group.

Q: If I add an Admin or Finance user to my group, will this take up a license even though they won't be using GitLab?

A: Yes, these users will count as a billable user, and will be charged for.

Q: I would like to give another user access to my subscription account in the GitLab Customers Portal. How do I do this?

A: It is possible you may be able to transfer ownership without GitLabs assistance. See this workflow for details. If the self-service options are unavailable to you, then please open a Support Ticket. You will be required to provide ownership verification, after which Support will transfer the ownership.

Q: I am part way through my GitLab subscription term and I would like to buy extra licenses for some recent hires. Am I able to do this?

A: Yes! Please see the below content on how to add users, based on your hosting model.

SaaS Subscription - How to Add User

Self Managed Subscription - How to Add User

GitLab Employee Focused Questions

Q: How can I check to see when my customers subscription is due for renewal?

A: You can find when a Customer is up for renewal by checking the Next Renewal Date field on the Account. If an Account has multiple Subscriptions you can navigate to the relevant Renewal Opportunity and check the Subscription Renewal Date.

Q: How can I check to see if my customer has successfully linked their GitLab.com user account to their Customers Portal user account?

A: Navigate to <<https://customers.gitlab.com/admin/customer/>> and search by customer email. Use the Zuora and Impersonate tabs to validate that the information in these portals matches the Customers Portal. Provider and Uid fields are also populated with values.

Q: How can I check to see if my customer has successfully linked their GitLab subscription to the GitLab namespace?

A: You will need to ask the customer to navigate to;

Settings - Billings (or gitlab.com/groups/<lululemon>namespace/-/billings) and check if the plan matches their invoice.

Q: When viewing my customers renewal opportunity, what is the difference between Close Date, Quote Start Date and Subscription Renewal Date?

A: For Open Opportunities the Close Date is the forecasted day we expect the deal to close. For Closed Opportunities the Close Date is the day the Opportunity was Closed. The Quote Start Date is the first day of the Subscription indicated by the Primary Quote on the Opportunity. Note that for Renewal Quotes the Quote Start Date will always be the same as the Subscription Renewal Date. The Subscription Renewal Date is the last day or expiry of the current active Subscription that is available to renew.

Q: How do I know if my customer is on Auto Renew?

A: Navigate to their active Subscription on their Account in Salesforce, and view the Turn On AutoRenew field. If it's set to Yes, then they are on auto renew.

Q: How do I know if my customer has turned off Auto Renew?

A: Navigate to their active Subscription on their Account in Salesforce, and view the Turn On AutoRenew field. If it's set to No, then they have cancelled/ turned off Auto Renew.

Q: I have heard it is possible that a customer on auto renew may not actually renew, due to unforeseen consequences e.g the credit card on the account has expired. How do I therefore know if my customer with actually auto renew?

A: Check the Auto Renewal Status on the Renewal Opportunity to confirm that the Subscription will auto-renew. If it will not auto renew, you will see the reason why. e.g CC Expired

Q: My customer auto-renewed but now wants to make changes/cancel their subscription. How do I manage this?

A: We always strive to ensure our customers are aware that their subscription will auto-renew, and any changes should be made prior to renewal. Reach out to Deal Desk in chatter by @ mentioning @ sales-support for guidance on how to manage such customer requests.

Q: How do I determine how much revenue my customer has up for renewal?

A: On the Renewal Opportunity the ARR Basis is the revenue Available to Renew (ATR)

Q: I think some Renewal Opportunity data is incorrect, who can I reach out to for review?

A: Reach out to Deal Desk in chatter by @ mentioning @ sales-support.

Q: How do I know if my customer is signed up for QSRs?

A: Navigate to their active Subscription on their Account in Salesforce, and view the Turn On Seat Reconciliation field in SFDC. If it's set to Yes, then they have QSRs turned on.

Q: How do I check the status of a QSR? i.e Does my customer have an outstanding QSR?

A: You can search for the subscription in CDot Admin Reconciliations section. It will show the status for all QSRs connected to that subscription.

Also, if the QSR opportunity is still open 15 days after it's creation, the QSR is considered outstanding. In this scenario, you should reach out to the customer and manually transact the overage.

Q: When should I manually manage a renewal opportunity?

A: If a customer is not on auto-renewal (Turn on Auto Renew = No) or if we know the auto-renewal will fail (Auto Renewal Status = On) we need to reach out to the customer to manage the renewal process directly. Large, strategic customer renewals should also be managed directly.

Q: When should I direct a customer to renew online, and how can I help them do that?

A: Advise them to log into the Customers Portal using their credentials. Once they have navigated to the Manage Purchases view, they should see an option to Renew. Once they have clicked on Renew and reviewed their order, they can proceed to checkout and select Purchase.

Q: How do I know if my customer has renewed via the online web store?

A: Once a customer follows the process outlined above, the renewal opportunity on the Account in Salesforce will be auto set to closed won.

Q: If my customer advised they want to purchase through the channel, what action should I take?

A: You can renew a Direct customer via the Channel within the existing Renewal Opportunity and following the Quoting process of Channel/Alliance quotes.

Q: If my customer wants to move from Self-Managed to a SaaS instance or vice-versa, what steps do I need to take?

A: This will involve the customer swapping product offerings. Therefore, if a customer wishes to change products at time of renewal, follow the standard Renewal Quoting process. If a Customer wishes to switch products during the contract term follow the Amendment Quoting process.

Q: My customer wants to consolidate multiple Subscriptions into one. How do I action this?

A: Reach out to Deal Desk for guidance as early as possible. If all the relevant Subscriptions are co-termed (have the same end dates) and the consolidation is occurring at the time of Renewal then build the quote with all the consolidating products on the Renewal Opportunity that is associated to the namespace that will remain active. Once the Order Form is signed, Submit the Opportunity for Booking. For the remaining Renewal Opportunities reach out to Deal Desk via chatter and request they be Closed Lost with Closed Lost Reason = Merged into another opportunity. In the instance where a customer is requesting to consolidate Subscriptions which requires one or more Subscriptions to be early-renewed then consolidate the Subscriptions via Contract Reset.

Q: My customer has exceed over their licenses count for the first time. What action should I take?

A: If the customer has exceed their license count (this info can be viewed under Draft Utilization on the Account), you can either sell them Add On licenses, or they can charged for licenses retroactively, and pro rated, via a QSR.

Other helpful resources

[Auto Renewal FAQ](#)

[How to subscribe to GitLab](#)

[Licensing FAQ](#)

[QSR Process](#)

[Cloud Licensing](#)

SECTION: sales/commercial/comm-sales-opp-stages/_index.md

*<i class="fas fa-users fa-fw icon-color font-awesome"></i>*Why Are Sales Stages So Important?

Pipeline management is key to predictable, scalable revenue attainment and can make the difference between simply hitting your number and overachieving. Proper sales pipeline management helps you allocate your time correctly, increase deal velocity, and increase total deal volume, size, and revenue through accurate forecasting practices.

A well-managed sales pipeline requires a clear process with defined activities and exit criteria that serve as a roadmap to getting a deal from discovery to closed won (or qualified out quickly). The following process is specific to the Commercial Sales team and will ensure

you have a clean pipeline and accurate forecast.

<i class="fas fa-users"></i>Commercial Sales Stages Activities and Exit Criteria

To view these stages in Google sheet format please click this link.

Exit Criteria at a Glance:

1-Discovery

Uncover as much intelligence about the project as you can, which will be confirmed at later stages throughout the sales cycle. Identify a business need or challenge the customer/prospect is trying to address and the potential for GitLab to solve.

Primary Activities to Complete in This Stage:

- Begin filling out MEDDPIC - Partner, Identify Pain, Competition
- Send Plan Letter/Recap Email to Attendees- Example
- Create custom deck and share with customer
- Identify Customer contact role
- Confirm Cloud Strategy & Partner engagement

Secondary Activities to Complete in This Stage:

These are the more granular steps required to complete the primary activities in this stage

- Fill out the Opportunity Overview of the Command Plan (Deal amount requirement thresholds: \$5k SMB, \$10k MM)
- Rank account
- Size the opportunity
- Understand the customers' partner landscape
- Custom deck shared with customer
- Understand customer's cloud strategy
- Identify the role of customer contact: Champion, Influencer, Economic Buyer, Technical Buyer, etc.
- Deliver the GitLab single app pitch and gather feedback from customer on vision
- Customers' near and long term priorities identified
- Next steps filled out

Exit Criteria:

These activities must be completed before moving the prospect to the next stage

- Recap email sent to customer confirming pain points, key stakeholders, next steps, project timeline
- Scoping meeting scheduled

- Provide an estimate for the Expected Number of Users and the Expected Product for the Opportunity. This information is used to help the Customer Success team to predict their future workload as well as to help them with their hiring plans.

3-Technical Evaluation

Validate the technical qualifications are a fit for the customer/prospect needs.

Primary Activities to Complete in This Stage:

- Channel and/or Alliances partner(s) engaged (if applicable)
- Customized demo
- Trial if applicable; SA determines if this will be SA assisted or self-managed by customer
- Follow up with additional stakeholders as needed
- MEDDPIC: Decision Criteria, Decision Process, Paper Process
- Vision pitch (why you should buy)

Secondary Activities to Complete in This Stage:

- Review/validate understanding of technical requirements with customer
- Recorded Tailored Demo with customer
- First Order or Named Accounts: SA may submit a request for a Slack channel if the technical evaluation has a need for a more asynchronous communication approach.
- SA will determine if trial is assisted by the SA or self-managed by customer
- Work with customer to determine success criteria for eval, time frame, and next steps
- Understand buying process, e.g. paper process, approvals, signatures, etc.
- If a trial license extension is being requested from a customer, discuss with AE and prepare a project plan with the customer before granting an extension.
- Other teams/business units identified that may need to be involved (Other points of entry)
- Additional demos scheduled for stakeholders with unique needs
- Opportunity Consults and Lightweight Deal Reviews with manager if monetary thresholds are met
- Identify the "why" if customer decides not to move forward and document reasons in SFDC/notes
- Next steps updated
- If the relationship is owned by a Partner, share applicable case studies, example projects, and/or relevant documentation
- If going through a Partner, ensure SA is briefed on the opportunity and any services SOWs

Exit Criteria:

- Demo output shared with customer (slide decks, recordings, collateral, etc.)
- ROI measures determined and validated
- Mutual agreement to move to proposal and identified next steps
- Professional Services identified and sourced (Partner or internal) if applicable
- MEDDPIC: Decision Criteria, Decision Process, Paper Process

5-Negotiating

Finalize the agreement, pricing, business, and legal terms.

Primary Activities to Complete in This Stage:

- Negotiate business terms
- Negotiate pricing
- Negotiate legal terms
- Confirm contacts to receive the digital onboarding emails post deal closure (< \$50K)

Secondary Activities to Complete in This Stage:

- Under \$50K: SA and AE can begin preparing the contacts to receive digital onboarding emails upon closing of a deal
- Agreement on business terms (All proposals should include the standard GitLab Terms)
- If the Account is seeking to use their own paper, requests will only be entertained if the opportunity is greater than \$100k, and the request should be sent to Legal by creating a Legal case in Salesforce, following the process found [here](#).
- Determine if customer will be referenceable when the opportunity closes
- Price/ Final terms negotiations
- Leverage partner to help close deal or support them in closing a Partner Sourced deal

Exit Criteria:

- Customer has agreed to business terms
- Customer has agreed to legal terms
- Quote & Agreement ready to be routed for signature
- AE has a clear timeline for when the OA will be signed and returned and implementation start date

7-Closing

Verifying the completeness of the documentation and opportunity to confirm ready to be Closed Won. Applies to sales assisted transactions only.

Primary Activities to Complete in This Stage:

- SFDC Opp, AE clicks "Submit for Approval" and adds Closed Won reason and details. This submits opp for approval and puts it to 7-Closing and locks the record from any further edits.
- Opp flows into a report for Deal Desk to review for booking
- Signed Order Form (OF) or PO referencing Quote
- Order Form matches quote and opportunity
- Order Form fully executed (Signature & Date)
- Approve with optional reason noted
- Approval status = Deal Desk Approved and goes to billing
- Billing reviews/approves and the becomes Closed Won and Approval Status = Approved
- If rejected, add notes on reasons and sends an email to the opp owner. Opp can take action

based on comments.

- If complicated, reject and send chatter to rep. Opp will revert back to Awaiting Signature, which unlocks the opp and the rep can respond.

Exit Criteria:

- Once Deal Desk and Billing approve the opp and change the Approval Status to Approved, the system automatically moves it to Closed Won

8-Closed Lost

An opportunity was lost and the prospect/customer has decided not to pursue the purchase of GitLab

Primary Activities to Complete in This Stage:

- Select all applicable SFDC Closed Lost Reasons
- Evaluate if the prospect should be placed in a specific nurture campaign
- Ensure all notes/next steps for potential re-engagement have been updated
- Schedule "check-in" calls to uncover new opportunities in high potential closed-lost accounts
- Where applicable schedule Partner call to review loss and explore future opportunities
- What lesson learned should you share with your manager to help progress your career?

SECTION: sales/commercial/enablement/_index.md

Welcome to the Commercial Sales Enablement Handbook Page

Commercial Field Certification - Required 7

To improve sales efficiency & predictability as well as excellence in role, the Field Enablement Team has developed a Field Certification program. The focus of this certification path for Commercial AEs is specific to the Required 7. All AE's are expected to complete this certification path after completing Sales and Customer Success Onboarding. All courses and learner assets are listed below:

Title	Learning Objective	Duration
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R7 Certification, Course 1: Effective Meeting Hosting	Ensure each AE/ASM can apply remote selling best practices to host a professional virtual meeting	20 min
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R7 Reinforcement Module: Meeting Roles	Ensure each AE/ASM can identify the correct co-selling role and apply in a given sales scenario	10 min
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R7 Certification, Course 2: Account Ranking	Ensure each AE/ASM can apply the Account Ranking criteria to build pipeline	20-25 min
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R7 Certification, Course 3: Capturing Key Information and Logging Call Notes & Updating Next Steps	Ensure each AE/ASM can translate the customers "question behind the question" to capture key information; recall where and how to log call notes; and create actionable next	
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steps | 25 min |

| R7 Certification, Course 4: Command Plan | Ensure each AE/ASM understand the CP architecture and can leverage informed curiosity to create a compelling "why now" and align value drivers with metrics to drive a sale to close | 30 min |

| R7 Certification, Course 5: Selling With The Custom Deck | Ensure each AE/ASM can apply the Custom Deck requirements to position GitLab as a differentiated solution | 30 min |

| | | |

Additional Commercial Courses

| Title | Learning Objective | Duration |

| ---- | ----- | ----- |

| Selling Services Workshop | Ensure each AE/ASM can identify and position Professional Service offerings and value | 90 min |

| AE Choice- The Journey to Ultimate
with James Heimbuck | Learn how to build a roadmap for customers to get to Ultimate; understand how specific
features in Ultimate help customers innovate as they scale; overcome objections by
understanding how uptier features solve business problems | 60 min |

Course Assets

| Course Title | Associated Course Asset |

| ----- | ----- |

| R7 Certification, Course 1: Effective Meeting Hosting | - Team Asset Folder
- Commercial Customer Deck Template
- How to custom brand the Commercial Sales Deck
- Video Tutorial: How to custom brand the Commercial Sales Deck
- Zoom Meeting Checklist
- ASMs: Chorus Feedback Resources |

| R7 Reinforcement Module: Meeting Roles | - Meeting Roles Infographic |

| R7 Certification, Course 2: Account Ranking | - Account Ranking Infographic |

| Selling Services Workshop | - Team Asset Folder
- Enablement for CS to Position Professional Services
- Professional Services Sales Enablement - Q3FY21
Internal Positioning Collateral for PS
- Nanotronics Deal Spotlight
- EWS Deal Spotlight |

Process for Capturing Customer Requests You've Never Heard Before

With all the uncertainty around Covid-19, we have developed a process to capture never-before-heard customer requests. Please use this document to help you understand the process.

Opp Management - Managers check this

Fields that need to be updated at all times

1. Close date

1. \$ value (by a t-shirt size). "T-shirt sizing" an opportunity is a way of estimating how much a prospect should be able to spend on GitLab for that transaction (new, add-on, or renewal). It's a way of shortening the size or complexity of the opportunity and is meant as a gut-check based on both data and your experience working with similar opportunities.

- Each opportunity created should have a dollar amount in the Incremental ACV field greater than \$0 to ensure visibility into pipeline and for forecasting purposes.

- Similar to account ranking, the advantage of sizing each opportunity is that it helps you

prioritize and allocate the right resources to optimize your iACV/hour. For example, if an opportunity is t-shirt sized larger, you might reach out on a daily basis to schedule the first meeting whereas your communication cadence might be every other day for a smaller sized opportunity. T-shirt sizing also gives you a sense of what resources (technical, leadership, etc.) might be needed to move the opportunity through the pipeline and increase your win rates.

- After reading SDR notes, the two key places to look at firmographic information are LinkedIn and Crunchbase. Data points to consider include where the company is located, employee size, as well who the contact is and at what level of the org they live. As an example, you may assess an opportunity in which there are more employees as a larger t shirt size. Remember, this is only an estimate - opportunity amounts can be refined after deeper discovery.

1. Opportunity name (needs to have tier and user count)

1. Account tier and tier notes

1. Primary contact

1. Next steps

1. Next Steps Date

1. Stage

1. Any activity that's logged while working the opportunity needs to be attached to the contact and the opportunity

- Best Practice is to log an activity in 'activity history'

- For Call activity types, associate the record with the correct contact(s) list and as needed, include (ii) in the record subject to call attention to information inside

1. Command Plan

How to get each of those required fields

1. Research online

1. Write the discussion questions you're going to ask to obtain the info

1. Qualification Indicators (101)

- How to get these - Qual 201

1. Other SFDC field requirements

1. Recap on the objections

- Review the list and reiterate that they're not acceptable reasons to not fill out those fields

Tiering Accounts

- Commercial Sales: Tiering Accounts Training Clippet

For more details visit the Account Ranking section on the Commercial Sales Handbook page.

Getting into Accounts That Say They Don't Have a Problem

In Concept

1. Each of us sales professionals makes a regular decision: where we apply our time. We are trying to optimize the ratio of output to time. Everything we do or work on should be judged by this ratio.

1. Each of us has a market to go after: note that most of our volumes of contacts to connect with is roughly similar - you either have:

- Lots of accounts with less contacts

- Or few accounts with many, many more contacts

1. We in MM and SMB use the Account Tiering fields to effectively show ourselves where we think there is a higher or lower level of this ratio.

Each person writes out a process:

1. First: come up with a t-shirt size for each account overall, and how far on the journey they are

1. Find all easily attainable contacts and put in SFDC

1. Prioritize in order of most likely to speak/reply

- Bucket into 3 groups: know nothing, know good info, and not sure value of what i know

1. Plan the method and type of content for reach out for each group/bucket

1. ID your ideal client: personally I want some form of intro-

- A slow valuable intro is better than most fast, cold connects

1. Get a 10-15 min connect in whatever way they prefer:

- Nice to meet you - how's it going?
- Give your credibility statement.
- Ask them if they think there is anyway that GitLab could help.
- When they say no, be sad. Then ask what challenges their team or they have.
- When they say yes, listen up and begin discovery, then bounce back to qualification to understand if its worth it for them to work on it.

1. Document all notes and immediately build the most compelling customized deck on why they should try GitLab

- See where the biggest gaps are in the deck, and if you aren't sure, role play with a colleague on it to see what is missing

1. ID EXACTLY the info missing to make it somewhat compelling

1. Go back to your list of contacts and find out who could best get you this info

The tougher, non-intro'd scenario:

1. Dig in on the persona of the contact info you have so you can reach out in a way that you have 100% confidence that this connect will result in 2-way communication

- This can be showing up at an event
- It can be somewhat person based
- It should never be creepy
- Think about how to give first

1. When coming up with a strategy, think about the specific reason that a person inside that company has NOT offered their contact info to GitLab, and figure out how to get over that single hump

Make sure that you document all:

1. Notes

1. Ideas

1. Internal strategy

Be sure to put in the status of this account in Account Tiering and Tiering Notes so that you can be efficient every time you or another person works on it

When is it Game Over?

1. It is game over when working on an account reveals information that moves it below another account you are working that surpasses it in terms of value.

1. Value = Worth (what you will get)/Cost (what you need to put in) x Risk (the chances you predict that your understanding of value and worth are accurate.

1. Value (in this specific effort) = how much the account is worth this FY/the time you need to get them to spend that amount

Sales Note Taking

GitLab is an organization that is built on contribution and collaboration. These values are not only critical for building a great product, they are critical for building a world class sales team. Each member of the Commercial team is expected to create insider notes in SFDC on accounts and conversations they participate in or currently own. With GitLab being a remote company, it is even more important to create and maintain a culture of great note taking.

Why Do We Take Notes on Accounts?

1. Capture insight and learning

- Notes draw out key insights that help you better understand GitLab's potential and existing customers. As you plan, organize and grow your territory, the discipline of note taking empowers you to scale your efforts, clarify needs, next steps and signals in ways your memory cannot.

- Note taking shares knowledge and guidance that the whole sales organization (from sales reps to leadership) can benefit from. Why are customers buying GitLab? What are their common challenges? Are we seeing interest from new groups of buyers? Notes on Salesforce are the corporate memory of the commercial team, if there are no notes, it increases the probability of wasted meetings.

1. Become better sales leaders

- Through note taking you position yourself to be great at your job, which is great for our potential and existing customers. Notes create a framework for how you can best help your customer. What is your next step following your call? What did the customer really want from GitLab Premium? Just check your notes.

1. Capture A Story

- Every conversation, opportunity or interaction with a potential or existing customer forms part of a story. Stories have chapters, a beginning, a middle and an end. Within the commercial team, stories provide resources and context for training and iteration, a key component on our journey to world class achievement.

Different Sections of Notes to Include

Raw Notes Section

- Sales call notes could be word-for-word transcripts or much less structured. They must include customer specific language and should always detail technologies and challenges in the customer's exact words (in the case of Kubernetes, spelling matters for future search). This portion is called raw notes. For example, who did you perceive to be the decision makers (DM's) and influencers (INF) in the meeting and why? What were the key points raised or asked? How did they feel? Were you unclear on certain things? What questions did you not know to ask at the time and what would you ask if you could do it again? These type of notes are primarily for you to recall noteworthy moments from the meeting that you can build upon.

Questions Section

- This section of notes reflects questions you have following your meeting. Do you need to find more decision makers? Need to think of a plan to win the renewal or new business? Jot down a few questions - that should be sufficient. Questions play the role of helping you recall the gaps you find from the meeting.

Summary Section

- These type of notes are not just for you. Rather, they benefit the entire sales team. Summaries focus on important, actionable and insightful points - things that will help you in you in your next meeting. Try and convey timelines where relevant, include dates, times of day, etc. Did you say you would follow up in the morning with a response before sending a quote? That's a great note to include. Lastly, when it comes to summaries, bullet points are our friends.

Next Steps Section

- Just as it sounds, "Next Steps" outline strategic actionable items that need to be acted upon by yourself, someone else in the team or a customer. Where possible, tag internal colleagues on tasks that relate to them and follow up with customers via email on tasks that relate to them. Next steps are great for handovers and business continuity, remember the story you're compiling? think of next steps as bookmarks - people can pick up the story where you leave them.

Notes Subject Line

- YOUR NAME/YOUR MANAGER NAME Internal (ii) WHAT YOUR NOTES ARE FROM
- Anthony/Ryan internal (ii) listened to chorus call OR TITLE

Where to Make Notes

Login to Salesforce to see where you should add notes. If no opportunity exists, create a note on the Contact level, if an Opportunity exists, create a note on the Opportunity level.

Characteristics of Next Steps

1. A colleague with a similar skill set should be able to pick up your notes, get an understanding of what's happened and take action quickly (within 3-5 minutes).
1. They should be compelling for the future version of you who will read them. If, when you read the next steps, you aren't motivated to take action at the exact time and day that you prescribe, you should iterate on them. Compelling next steps are specific, concise, actionable and efficient. Please think about our values of transparency, collaboration, efficiency and results.
1. Next Steps and actions, once completed, will add value to the customer's GitLab experience and journey. They are impactful.

Example: Vanilla Notes vs Great Notes

- A Vanilla Note: "Follow up with Anthony next week."

- Great Note: "Send an email to Anthony (our 1 champion at XYZ Corp) next Tuesday morning at 10 his time to confirm he got sign off from Ryan on Premium: 'Anthony, did you have a chance to present the ROI slide we created? I'd love to hear feedback on those numbers.'" [RO note: the statement in single quotes should actually be written in your next steps so that you could cut and paste it into and email verbatim.]

This Sales Team takes great notes!

Commercial sales account health check process

Objective

To build and maintain positive relationships with customers at every stage of their GitLab journey. Positive customer relations help you connect with your customers on a much more personal level. When you connect with the target audience, you are much more likely to understand their requirements, resolve their problems, and create a sense of mutual understanding.

Goal

Understand the importance of customer health checks to create lasting relationships with GitLab customers. This reduces churn and increases expanded opportunities.

Lifecycle stages & engagement

First order (Pre-Sale-Day 1): The objective is to prepare the customer for a successful customer journey with GitLab, meaning they can achieve their business outcomes with a great experience. This includes evaluating our products for their needs, clearly defining their buying process and determining the timeline of key milestones to ensure a seamless handoff.

Implementation (Day 1-Day 90): This is a very important step in the customer lifecycle. During the implementation stage the customer is evaluating their needs and how GitLab is going to ensure they meet those needs. There may be learning opportunities that present themselves, so multiple touches will take place to ensure we provide support to move them into the adoption stage.

- Schedule first meeting w/customer within 7 days of first order. Invite appropriate CS/CSM partners based on scope.
- On first call review notes from FO process on what they want to accomplish w/GL over the subscription period and in what order
- Define goals for first 30 days of license (get users added, first project setup, migrate repos, etc)
- Schedule appropriate follow up calls for technical teams based on requirements
- Schedule & Complete 30 day check-in to ensure customer is on track to first value/first adoption
- Assess customer needs based on 30 day check in and schedule appropriate follow up calls w/internal/partner resources to ensure full adoption/value by 90th day based on customers initial use case

Adoption (Day 90-270): The objective is to support our customer's utilization of the GitLab

solution to address the customer's original purchase intent (i.e., use case(s) and capabilities, licenses).

- Day 90 Call - review implementation phase and confirm adoption was successful, schedule appropriate follow ups as necessary. Review key milestones from initial purchase and assess if on track based on business progress or if anything has changed. Schedule appropriate follow up calls to position additional GitLab features/services based on milestones
- Milestone calls to review achievements and present additional GitLab features ideally 90 days before needed to give customers enough time to eval, trial and decide. Ensure that all email/phone communications are supported by marketing insights or customer content housed in Highspot
- Schedule first renewal meeting for renewal phase

Renewal (Day 270-365): At this stage in the customer journey, there is full application of GitLab products and development is underway. The objective in this stage is to enable the customer to get additional value from the platform and stay current on project timelines.

- Day 270 call - conduct initial renewal meeting. Review key stats - GL license utilization, company sentiment, product utilization, additional areas would like to evaluate (ultimate or services) and proposed user count/tier for upcoming renewal
 - Use the renewal call checklist/deck provided to conduct initial renewal call: EBR Template
- Schedule follow up calls accordingly based on initial renewal call to allow customer time to eval additional features, get user count, procurement or legal processes worked out
- Day 365 successful renewal

SFDC Reports to assist: Customer Health Check Dashboard

For more specific step by step processes, see below for links to individual roles and responsibilities.

[SMB First Order]

[SMB Pooled]

[SMB First Year Expand]

[SMB Named]

MM Territory

MM Named

SECTION: sales/commercial/enablement/required7.md

Guide to the Required 7

Why do we need the Required 7?

It's Monday morning. You have just opened up your laptop. You've got 4 customer calls for Ultimate upgrades, 1 IQM to prepare for and 2 quotes to do. You know this because your next steps are clear and up to date.

Your first call is for an Ultimate upgrade. You have already put a deck together, and you double check your call notes to make sure you haven't missed anything. Turns out they mentioned

that they needed disaster recovery when you spoke to them a couple of weeks ago and you were reminded of this because it was in your call notes. You add a slide or two to cover DR.

You get on the call. The customer is still impressed that your deck is in their colors. You recap the last conversation and take the customer through the reasons why Ultimate is ideal for them. You know security is important because they've mentioned it to you a few times on calls now as per your call notes. They like what they see, but the price seems a bit high. But you've already thought about that and go through the ROI of using Ultimate. You end the call agreeing to send over a quote and confirm that you will have a check-in in a week's time. You update your next steps in line with the check-in call date, change the opp stage, update the close dates and paste your raw notes from the deck into a call log.

Next up, you need to send out those two quotes. You create the quotes, send them via Sertifi and update your next steps to remind you to follow-up with the customer in 2 days' time.

You get an alert - a Zendesk ticket has been created. It's a tier 2 customer, so you have a quick look and see the customer's got a problem with their pipelines. You know Support is on it, so you leave it and set a next step to check if they're happy with the resolution in a couple of days.

You have an IQM tomorrow morning, so you spend 15 minutes preparing. You create the deck in the customer's branding. You add in info from the SDR's notes and add the link to the deck in the opp. It's 25 Premium, so you add in the questions you'll ask in your command plan. You update the next step to remind yourself to update the opp once the IQM has finished.

It's time to update your forecast. It takes 10 minutes in Clari because most of the information is already there, as your opportunities in Salesforce are all up to date.

You've now got some time to do some investigation on some of your accounts. You go through your tier 2s and find some that you haven't spoken to in a couple of months. You email them asking if they are available for a call next week - you'd love to get them a 2 week trial of Premium. Finally, you have some time to clear your inbox and catch up on Slack messages!

What are the Required 7?

Required component	Detail	Why?
Logging call notes with (ii) in the title	Every verbal interaction with an account is logged.	It is important to have a log of what was discussed previously, as no one has a memory that good. It also enables your buddy or manager to take over. In addition, the Customer Success Managers, Solutions Architects and Product teams review call notes for their own jobs.

Rank/tier all of your accounts
Any customer with CARR higher than 0 or any prospect with an open opportunity needs to be ranked.
We have to portion out our time relative to the potential of the account. It is also used for sales campaigns to focus on the customers where we will get the best return on our efforts.
Keep your next steps up to date
Next steps must be up to date <u>every day</u>
Time kills deals and we have a lot of opps - next steps are the way to keep on top of opps, resulting in more deals closed and a better customer experience.
Your opportunities have to be up to date
\$ amount, opp name, type, stage & close dates must be accurate at all times
Enables you to forecast with precision.
Command plans for all deals over \$5k amount or \$10k ARR (SMB) or \$10k amount or \$20k ARR (Mid-Market)
Overview section must be completed for deals over \$5k in SMB (Total Contract Value, not ARR) or \$10k in Mid-Market. Full for deals over \$10k ARR in SMB or \$20k in Mid-Market
The command plan is a guide of how well qualified your opportunity is and signposts what needs to happen next. If you have not spoken to the customer yet, then add in questions you will ask in the Command Plan fields. If the deal is going through a partner then work with the partner and the Channel Account Manager (CAM) to get the answers required.
Custom pitch deck built for all opps over \$5k amount (SMB) or \$10k amount (Mid-Market)
Requirements
It helps you sell on value rather than just features and it arms your champion with the info they need to get sign-off internally to buy GitLab. Lastly, it makes you stand out as a sales rep.
Capture key information
What is the customer's understanding of what GitLab does should be captured in call notes. We also record why we won / lost a deal
It helps us develop our market. Recording win and loss reasons means we can accelerate what is helping us win deals and fix what is making us lose deals.

The required 7 are not optional. They must be up to date by 5pm in your timezone every day. If you are on PTO or otherwise out, your back-up is required to help. AEs are expected to cover as much as they possibly can before taking time off, so as not to leave the backup with a huge

workload.

The 7 in detail

1/ Call notes

When to do it

You should log your call notes immediately after the call. Even better: during the call. It is required that all verbal interactions with customers are logged as call notes, this includes if you are shadowing the call or doing a prep call.

How to do it

Good call notes include:

- Raw notes (the notes as you wrote them during the meeting)
- Questions you didn't ask - for example, what did you need to find out that you weren't able to get on the call?
- A summary, a few bullet points on the key things mentioned in the meeting
- Next steps, a summary of what needs to happen next that YOU will action and these should be pasted into your next steps on the opportunity too

Call notes must be logged against the opportunity record, NOT the account. This means others can find them a lot easier and makes reporting more accurate, enabling us to tune our sales processes for better results. It is the AE's responsibility to ensure that call notes are logged against the opportunity.

Examples & further resources

- Good call notes overall: <https://gitlab.my.salesforce.com/00T4M00002bJ1e5>
- Bad call notes: <https://gitlab.my.salesforce.com/0064M00000VMA7C>
- Video: how to take notes during a meeting
- Video: Lisa van de Kooij's tips on taking good notes

Pro tips

- If the deal is low value, the call notes do not have to be perfect, detailed essays. A paragraph summary is fine.
- You can copy and paste your notes from your custom deck and this is encouraged for efficiency.
- Using a template for notes is a way of completing notes quicker.
- Your notes should not take more than a couple of minutes to tidy up after a call if you take raw notes during the call.

2/ Ranking your accounts

The goal of ranking your accounts (customers AND prospects) is to enable you to prioritize your time and proactively work on the right customers with the right amount of effort. When your accounts are ranked effectively, you can work on a cadence that helps you grow ARR by spending the right amount of time depending on the potential and current value of the customer/prospect.

It also gives you the opportunity to verify if the account is correctly aligned to you and, if not, take corrective action as per the Rules of Engagement.

When to do it

You should rank your accounts within 24 hours of getting them assigned to you. Accounts that require ranking will appear in your team's Required 7 dashboard.

Important: you should also re-rank your accounts when you get new information on them.

How to do it

Do some brief research on the customer's employee count, LinkedIn Insights, latest news, current subscription (or license tier of interest if it's a prospect) and make a judgement on its potential. You must verify that the account is correctly aligned to you during this exercise and if it's incorrect, request that it is moved. Once you have decided which rank it should be in, mark the account as such in Salesforce and enter notes that outline why you chose that rank. You can also check out the account ranking section on the handbook for more detailed information.

Here are some things to consider when ranking an account:

- Rank 1s and 1.5s are those accounts that you will pay most attention to - which ones are most worthy of the most time? Which customers and prospects will get you the most ARR this year?
- Rank 2s are generally your future growth accounts that you will work proactively
- Rank 3s will be mostly reactive and high-volume
- Consider both the potential growth in the customer/prospect and the impact if they churned

Examples & further resources

Video: Ryan O'Neill going through how to efficiently rank your accounts

Pro tips

- Get into the habit of double-checking an account's rank whenever you engage with it.
- Include your sources that you have checked, so you can check them again when you re-rank the account in the future.
- Re-rank the account when you get it. Your rank 3 may be the previous AE's rank 2.
- Use inline editing to quickly update multiple accounts at once.

3/ Keeping next steps up to date

Think of your next steps as your daily to-do list. They should be the priority for you to follow-up on every day, as they mean you keep your promises to your customers and close deals faster.

When to do it

Immediately after the last action you took with the customer. Today's next steps should be the first thing you look at in the morning.

How to do it

In the next steps field in an opportunity, put in the next actions you will take. It should be written in such a way that someone else would easily be able to pick it up if you were on PTO or otherwise unavailable. Please do not use it as a log of what you have already done (that should be in your call notes) and please avoid ambiguous steps such as "follow up" or "email".

Pro tips

- Use an opportunity view in Salesforce to work through your next steps.
- Remember, you have to set next steps on all opportunities. Not doing so is essentially saying, "I'm not doing anything with this opportunity"
- If prospect or customer 'goes dark', next step should reflect what you would do IF they reply back. Then if the prospect reaches back out, reopen the opportunity.

4/ Keeping your opportunities up to date

You know how annoying it is having to switch between Salesforce and Clari when doing your forecast, because you need a reminder of where all your opps are? Equally, know how annoying it is when your ASM is constantly asking you for the status of a deal? This is how you avoid that. So you can forecast accurately, make sure your opportunities are up to date at all times.

When to do it

Immediately after an interaction with the account and check through all your open opportunities every day before you log off for the day.

How to do it

Make sure your opportunities have the following up to date at all times:

- No zero dollar values
- Opportunity name has the license tier and number of licenses
- Close dates follow close date conventions
- Close dates are not in the past
- Next steps are up to date
- Opportunity type should be accurate (new business, add-on, renewal)
- Sales stage must reflect the current status of the opportunity
- The opportunity should not be left open if it is clearly not going anywhere

Examples & further resources

Video: How to make sure opps are up to date

5/ Creating Command Plans

Command Plans are your guide throughout your opportunities. They signpost where you should steer the conversation next. As a general rule of thumb, the more information you have, the better qualified your deal is and the more likely it is to come in.

When to do it

They should be created as soon as you have spoken to the account. If you have not yet spoken to them, then the command plan must be filled in with the questions you will ask when you do speak to them. If the deal is going through a partner then work with the partner and the Channel Account Manager (CAM) to get the answers required.

You need to continually update your Command Plan with every interaction with an account. A good Command Plan will get more content over time. Opportunities in stage 2 or above must have real information in the Command Plan, i.e. no template questions.

How to do it

Navigate to your opportunity and hit the Command Plan button. Enter in the information / questions in the fields.

For deals over \$5k AMOUNT but less than \$10k ARR (SMB) or \$10k AMOUNT but less than \$20k AMOUNT (MM)

- Opportunity Overview

For deals over \$10k ARR (SMB) or \$20k (MM)

All of the above and:

- MEDDPIC
- Close Plan Details

Examples & further resources

- A good command plan
- A bad command plan
- An example of a command plan filled in BEFORE speaking to a customer

6/ Custom pitch decks

Pitch decks are the foundation of your relationship with the customer or prospect. They are the ongoing record of interaction and, when used properly, seed further opportunities within the account in the future.

When to do it

Pitch decks should be created prior to any two-way conversation with an account with an opportunity (renewal or new/additional) amount over \$5k (SMB) or \$10k (MM). They must contain ALL the required elements (see 'How to do it' below) and MUST be sent to the customer after each Zoom call or face-to-face meeting.

You need to continually update your pitch deck with every interaction with an account. They should be used in every two-way conversation.

How to do it

Please review the how to update the commercial slide deck document.

Examples & further resources

- A good pitch deck
- Pitch deck requirements

Pro tips

- If you are selling through the channel, create the pitch deck for the channel partner. This has the added benefit of being repeatable with any other deals through that partner - i.e. you only do it once.
- You can copy and paste your notes from the deck into your call notes to save a lot of time

7/ Recording key information

To ensure GitLab is pitched at the right level to the right customers, it's important that the company knows what the perception is of GitLab in the marketplace. As a direct sales team, we are best placed to get and record the information.

When to do it

After your first interaction with an account. If you've already interacted with them before but not asked them, it should be done after your next interaction with them.

How to do it

Add the information to your call notes.

Examples & further resources

- There will be a field in Salesforce at some point, but for now, please continue to log the information in your call notes.

SECTION: sales/commissions/index.md

Charter

Sales Commissions is a part of Field Operations, reporting into Sales Operations. Our goal is to incentivize the field to close business, process commissions in an accurate and timely fashion to help make GitLab more successful. We aim to be viewed as a trusted business partner for Field Sales, Lead Generation and management.

Quota setting and Compensation Design are led by the Go-To-Market Planning & Operations team. This team sits under Sales Strategy & Analytics, also a part of Field Operations, and work hand-in-hand with the Sales Commissions team. Our goal is to engender growth for the CRO org by

setting ambitious but achievable quotas and motivating our team members to act in the best interests of the company and of our customers.

Meet The Team

- Lisa Puzar, Sr. Manager, Sales Commissions
- Swetha Kashyap, Manager, Sales Commissions
- Sophie Hamann, Sr. Sales Commissions Analyst
- Anna Taylor, Sales Commissions Analyst
- Darren Chin, Sales Commissions Analyst

- Jake Bielecki, VP, Field Operations
- James Harrison, Sr. Director, Sales Operations
- Alex Cohen, Sr. Director, GTM Planning & Operations
- Haseen Selim, Sr. Analyst, GTM Planning & Operations

The detailed Sales Commissions Handbook has been relocated to the GitLab Internal Handbook.

SECTION: sales/field-communications/_index.md

Welcome to the Field Communications Page

This team is responsible for creating effective, timely, and easily consumable communications with the Field team (Sales, Customer Success, Channel, Alliances, Revenue Strategy, Operations & Enablement). Our goal is to help the field sell better, faster, and smarter with communication programs that keep them better informed of organizational/business updates that impact their roles, as well as useful resources that will enable day-to-day work.

For more information about the Field Enablement team, visit the team handbook page.

How to work with us

1. Review this page for information about our Field Communications programs, channels and processes.
2. Engage the Field Communications team by submitting a Field Announcement Request

Primary Field Communications Programs

Field Communications uses the channels outlined in this communication channel map to communicate with the Field. Key programs include:

- Field-FYI Slack Channel
- Field Flash Newsletter
- Field Update Tickers
- Field Alerts
- WW Field Org & WW Field Manager Calls
- Field Google Group and Slack Channel landscape

- See this link for how best to communicate with the Field team on Slack or via email.

Field Communications Playbook

In order to streamline important announcements and reduce noise for the Field team, we operate by a set Field Communications Playbook process. This playbook defines tier 1-5 organizational announcements/changes and applies a communication roll-out plan to each.

The Field Communications team will evaluate each request at the given point in time and tier it appropriately across three criteria:

1. Impact: The announcement affects the Field's current priorities and/or day-to-day work.
1. Relevancy: The announcement directly affects Field team members ability to perform selling-related job duties.
1. Urgency: The announcement and/or action required is time-bound and/or aligned to a company/CRO OKR.

For T1 and T2 announcements, Field Communications enacts a Manager Cascade motion to ensure Field people leaders are properly informed and enabled on major initiatives ahead of their team members.

T1:

1. 1-2 months prior: Heads up in WW Field Manager Call
2. 2-4 weeks prior: Initiative covered in segment VP's leadership meeting by leader or Enablement PM
3. 2-4 days prior: CRO Leaders provided with announcement copy they share with their managers
4. 1 day prior: field-manager message sent

T2:

1. 2-4 weeks prior: Initiative covered in segment VP's leadership meeting by Enablement PM
2. 1 day prior: field-manager message sent

To support the GitLab value of transparency, an overview of each Tier along with practical use cases and communication channels is provided below.

Tier 1 Update

This update highly impacts the Field's current priorities and/or day-to-day work, is highly relevant to all segments of the Field organization and is highly urgent (requiring immediate action and/or focus by a particular date). These updates are deemed the most important for the Field and will be addressed in all available Field Communication channels/motions. Field Enablement is likely required, and the Field Enablement team should